

THE ULTIMATE KNITTING LIBRARY

# The Knitter's Toolkit

Your Complete Quick-Reference Guide

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## SECTION 1

# Needle Size Chart

Every needle size at a glance — US, UK/Canadian, and Metric — with the yarn weight each one pairs with best.

*Keep this chart next to your pattern. A quick cross-reference eliminates guesswork when switching between sizing systems.*

| US SIZE | METRIC (MM) | UK/CANADIAN | RECOMMENDED YARN WEIGHT |
|---------|-------------|-------------|-------------------------|
| 0       | 2.0         | 14          | Lace / Fingering        |
| 1       | 2.25        | 13          | Fingering / Super Fine  |
| 1.5     | 2.5         | 12          | Fingering / Super Fine  |
| 2       | 2.75        | 12          | Fingering / Super Fine  |
| 2.5     | 3.0         | 11          | Sport / Fine            |
| 3       | 3.25        | 10          | Sport / Fine / DK       |
| 4       | 3.5         | 9           | DK / Light Worsted      |
| 5       | 3.75        | 9           | DK / Light Worsted      |
| 6       | 4.0         | 8           | DK / Worsted            |
| 7       | 4.5         | 7           | Worsted / Aran          |
| 8       | 5.0         | 6           | Worsted / Aran          |
| 9       | 5.5         | 5           | Worsted / Aran          |
| 10      | 6.0         | 4           | Bulky                   |
| 10.5    | 6.5         | 3           | Bulky                   |
| 10.75   | 7.0         | 2           | Bulky                   |
| 11      | 8.0         | 0           | Bulky / Super Bulky     |
| 13      | 9.0         | 00          | Super Bulky             |

| US SIZE | METRIC (MM) | UK/CANADIAN | RECOMMENDED YARN WEIGHT |
|---------|-------------|-------------|-------------------------|
| 15      | 10.0        | 000         | Super Bulky             |
| 17      | 12.0        | —           | Super Bulky             |
| 19      | 15.0        | —           | Super Bulky / Jumbo     |
| 35      | 19.0        | —           | Jumbo                   |
| 50      | 25.0        | —           | Jumbo                   |

**Tip**

When a pattern says “4mm needles,” that is the metric size. Look across the row to find the US or UK equivalent.

**Watch Out**

UK/Canadian sizing runs in the opposite direction from US sizing — a higher UK number means a *smaller* needle. Always double-check with the millimeter column.

**Needle Types at a Glance**

**Straight Needles**

Classic single-pointed needles, best for flat knitting. Available in lengths from 9" to 14". Ideal for scarves, blanket panels, and dishcloths.

**Circular Needles**

Two short tips connected by a flexible cable. Used for knitting in the round (hats, sleeves) and for flat pieces too wide for straights. Cable lengths: 16" to 60".

**Double-Pointed (DPNs)**

Sets of 4 or 5 short needles pointed at both ends. Essential for small-circumference knitting: socks, mittens, and glove fingers.

**Interchangeable Sets**

Detachable tips that screw onto cables of varying lengths. One set replaces dozens of fixed circulars. Best investment for frequent knitters.

## SECTION 2

# Yarn Weight Guide

The eight standard yarn weight categories — what each one looks like, how it knits, and what to make with it.

*Yarn weight is the single most important factor in choosing yarn for a project. This table covers all CYC (Craft Yarn Council) standard categories.*

| WEIGHT | CATEGORY               | WPI    | GAUGE<br>(4"/10CM) | NEEDLE<br>(US) | NEEDLE<br>(MM) | COMMON USES                                  |
|--------|------------------------|--------|--------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 0      | Lace                   | 30–40+ | 32–34 sts          | 000–1          | 1.5–2.25       | Lace shawls, doilies, wedding veils          |
| 1      | Fingering / Super Fine | 14–30  | 27–32 sts          | 1–3            | 2.25–3.25      | Socks, lightweight shawls, baby clothes      |
| 2      | Sport / Fine           | 12–18  | 23–26 sts          | 3–5            | 3.25–3.75      | Baby items, light sweaters, wraps            |
| 3      | DK / Light Worsted     | 11–15  | 21–24 sts          | 5–7            | 3.75–4.5       | Sweaters, baby blankets, hats                |
| 4      | Worsted / Medium       | 9–12   | 16–20 sts          | 7–9            | 4.5–5.5        | Sweaters, blankets, scarves, amigurumi       |
| 5      | Bulky / Chunky         | 7–9    | 12–15 sts          | 9–11           | 5.5–8.0        | Thick hats, cowls, rugs, quick blankets      |
| 6      | Super Bulky / Roving   | 5–7    | 7–11 sts           | 11–17          | 8.0–12.0       | Quick throws, bulky cowls, arm-knit projects |
| 7      | Jumbo                  | 1–5    | 6 sts or fewer     | 17+            | 12.0–25.0      | Arm knitting, giant blankets, extreme knits  |

### What Is WPI?

**Wraps Per Inch** — wrap the yarn around a ruler for one inch without stretching or leaving gaps. Count the wraps. This is the fastest way to identify an unlabeled yarn's weight.

## Quick Fiber Reference

### Animal Fibers

**Wool** — warm, elastic, felts easily. **Merino** — soft, non-itchy wool. **Alpaca** — silky warmth, no memory. **Cashmere** — luxury softness, delicate. **Mohair** — fluffy halo, strong fiber. **Silk** — beautiful drape, cool hand.

### Plant & Synthetic Fibers

**Cotton** — crisp, cool, no stretch. **Linen** — sturdy, softens with washing. **Bamboo** — silky drape, breathable. **Acrylic** — budget-friendly, machine washable. **Nylon** — adds strength (great in sock blends). **Polyester** — durable, quick-dry.

## SECTION 3

# Gauge Calculator

How to make a swatch, measure it accurately, and calculate the adjustments that make your finished piece fit perfectly.

*Gauge is the number of stitches and rows per unit of measurement. Skipping gauge is the number-one reason projects end up the wrong size.*

## How to Make a Gauge Swatch

- 1 **Cast on extra stitches.** If the pattern says 20 sts = 4", cast on at least 28–32 stitches. You need a border of several stitches on each side — edge stitches distort the measurement.
- 2 **Knit at least 5 inches.** Work in the stitch pattern specified (usually stockinette). Knit enough rows so you can measure 4" of fabric away from the cast-on and bind-off edges.
- 3 **Bind off loosely and wash.** Treat the swatch exactly as you will treat the finished item — hand wash, machine wash, or block it. Yarn can change dramatically after washing.
- 4 **Lay flat and let dry completely.** Pin it out if the pattern calls for blocking. Do not stretch it.

## How to Measure

- 1 **Place a ruler horizontally** across the center of the swatch (away from edges). Count the number of stitches across exactly 4 inches (10 cm). Include half-stitches.
- 2 **Place the ruler vertically** and count the number of rows in 4 inches.
- 3 **Repeat at least twice** in different spots. Average the results for accuracy.

## The Gauge Formula

### Stitch Gauge Formula

**Your gauge** = stitches counted ÷ inches measured

**Stitches needed** = desired width (inches) × your stitch gauge

**Rows needed** = desired length (inches) × your row gauge

## Worked Example

**Pattern gauge:** 20 sts and 28 rows = 4" on US 7 (4.5mm) needles.

**Your swatch:** You count 22 sts and 30 rows in 4".

Your stitch gauge is tighter. You have two options:

- 1 Change needle size (preferred).** Go up one needle size (US 8 / 5.0mm) and swatch again. Larger needles produce fewer stitches per inch. Repeat until you match the pattern gauge.
- 2 Recalculate stitch counts.** If the pattern says to cast on 100 sts for a 20" chest panel:  $20" \times (22 \text{ sts} \div 4") = 20 \times 5.5 = 110 \text{ sts}$ . You would need 110 stitches instead of 100.

## Adjustment Quick-Reference

| PROBLEM                             | YOUR GAUGE VS. PATTERN | FIX                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Too many stitches per inch          | Tighter                | Go up 1 needle size                                                                      |
| Too few stitches per inch           | Looser                 | Go down 1 needle size                                                                    |
| Stitch gauge matches, row gauge off | Mixed                  | Adjust length by working more or fewer rows; measure in inches rather than counting rows |
| Both off by more than 1 st per inch | Very different         | Try a completely different needle material (wood vs. metal) or re-evaluate yarn weight   |

### Common Mistake

Measuring the swatch while it is still on the needles or before washing. Always bind off, wash, dry, and then measure.

## Gauge Swatch Checklist

- ☐ Cast on at least 8 extra stitches beyond the gauge measurement
- ☐ Worked in the correct stitch pattern
- ☐ At least 5" (13 cm) tall
- ☐ Bound off and removed from needles
- ☐ Washed and dried the same way the finished piece will be
- ☐ Measured in multiple spots and averaged
- ☐ Stitch gauge recorded: \_\_\_\_ sts / 4"
- ☐ Row gauge recorded: \_\_\_\_ rows / 4"

## SECTION 4

# Abbreviation Glossary

Over 100 standard knitting abbreviations so you can read any pattern with confidence.

*Knitting patterns use abbreviations to save space. This glossary covers the ones you will encounter in virtually every pattern, plus many advanced ones.*

| ABBR.  | MEANING                                                                   |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| alt    | alternate                                                                 |
| approx | approximately                                                             |
| beg    | begin / beginning                                                         |
| bet    | between                                                                   |
| BO     | bind off                                                                  |
| BOR    | beginning of round                                                        |
| C4B    | cable 4 back: slip 2 sts to cn, hold in back, k2, k2 from cn              |
| C4F    | cable 4 front: slip 2 sts to cn, hold in front, k2, k2 from cn            |
| CC     | contrast color                                                            |
| cn     | cable needle                                                              |
| CO     | cast on                                                                   |
| cont   | continue                                                                  |
| CDD    | central double decrease: sl 2 sts tog knitwise, k1, pass slipped sts over |
| dec    | decrease / decreasing                                                     |
| dpn(s) | double-pointed needle(s)                                                  |
| EOR    | every other row                                                           |
| est    | established                                                               |

| ABBR.         | MEANING                                                                        |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| foll          | following                                                                      |
| g st          | garter stitch (knit every row)                                                 |
| inc           | increase / increasing                                                          |
| k             | knit                                                                           |
| k1b / k1-b    | knit 1 through the back loop                                                   |
| k2tog         | knit 2 stitches together (right-leaning decrease)                              |
| k3tog         | knit 3 stitches together                                                       |
| kfb           | knit into front and back of same stitch (increase)                             |
| kw            | knitwise                                                                       |
| LH            | left-hand                                                                      |
| lp(s)         | loop(s)                                                                        |
| m             | marker                                                                         |
| M1            | make 1 stitch (generic lifted increase)                                        |
| M1L           | make 1 left: lift bar between sts from front to back, knit through back loop   |
| M1R           | make 1 right: lift bar between sts from back to front, knit through front loop |
| M1P           | make 1 purlwise                                                                |
| MC            | main color                                                                     |
| meas          | measures                                                                       |
| mult          | multiple                                                                       |
| oz            | ounce(s)                                                                       |
| p             | purl                                                                           |
| p2tog         | purl 2 stitches together                                                       |
| pat(s) / patt | pattern(s)                                                                     |
|               |                                                                                |

| ABBR.      | MEANING                                                             |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| pfb        | purl into front and back of same stitch (increase)                  |
| pm         | place marker                                                        |
| prev       | previous                                                            |
| pssso      | pass slipped stitch over                                            |
| p2sso      | pass 2 slipped stitches over                                        |
| pu         | pick up                                                             |
| pw         | purlwise                                                            |
| rem        | remain / remaining                                                  |
| rep        | repeat                                                              |
| rev St st  | reverse stockinette stitch (purl side is RS)                        |
| RH         | right-hand                                                          |
| rib        | ribbing                                                             |
| rnd(s)     | round(s)                                                            |
| RS         | right side (public side of fabric)                                  |
| sc         | single crochet (used in some finishing)                             |
| sk         | skip                                                                |
| sk2p       | slip 1, knit 2 together, pass slipped stitch over (double decrease) |
| SKP / skpo | slip, knit, pass slipped stitch over (same as ssk in some patterns) |
| sl         | slip                                                                |
| sl st      | slip stitch                                                         |
| sl1k       | slip 1 knitwise                                                     |
| sl1p       | slip 1 purlwise                                                     |
| sm         | slip marker                                                         |
|            |                                                                     |

| ABBR. | MEANING                                                             |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ssk   | slip, slip, knit (left-leaning decrease)                            |
| sssk  | slip, slip, slip, knit (double decrease)                            |
| ssp   | slip, slip, purl through back loops                                 |
| st(s) | stitch(es)                                                          |
| St st | stockinette stitch (knit RS, purl WS)                               |
| tbl   | through the back loop                                               |
| tog   | together                                                            |
| w&t   | wrap and turn (short rows)                                          |
| WS    | wrong side (back side of fabric)                                    |
| wyib  | with yarn in back                                                   |
| wyif  | with yarn in front                                                  |
| yd(s) | yard(s)                                                             |
| yo    | yarn over (wrap yarn around needle to create a new stitch / eyelet) |
| yo2   | yarn over twice (double yarn over)                                  |
| yrn   | yarn round needle (UK term for yo between purl stitches)            |

## Symbols You May See in Charts

| SYMBOL          | MEANING (RS) | MEANING (WS) |
|-----------------|--------------|--------------|
| ⬜ (empty box)   | Knit         | Purl         |
| •               | Purl         | Knit         |
| O               | Yarn over    | Yarn over    |
| / (right slant) | K2tog        | P2tog        |
| \ (left slant)  | SSK          | SSP          |
| ><              | Cable cross  | —            |

| SYMBOL         | MEANING (RS)                  | MEANING (WS) |
|----------------|-------------------------------|--------------|
| ■ (filled box) | No stitch (placeholder)       | No stitch    |
| V              | Knit into front & back (kfb)  | Pfb          |
| Λ              | Central double decrease (CDD) | —            |

**Reading Tip**

Charts are read right to left on RS rows and left to right on WS rows — just like the direction you are actually knitting. Odd-numbered rows are usually RS.

SECTION 5

# Conversion Tables

Yards to meters, ounces to grams, inches to centimeters — every conversion you need while working from patterns in different measurement systems.

Many patterns originate in countries that use metric, while yarn labels in North America show imperial. These tables make switching painless.

## Length: Yards ↔ Meters

| YARDS | METERS | YARDS | METERS |
|-------|--------|-------|--------|
| 1     | 0.91   | 150   | 137    |
| 5     | 4.57   | 200   | 183    |
| 10    | 9.14   | 250   | 229    |
| 25    | 22.9   | 300   | 274    |
| 50    | 45.7   | 400   | 366    |
| 75    | 68.6   | 500   | 457    |
| 100   | 91.4   | 1000  | 914    |

### Quick Formula

Yards × 0.9144 = Meters | Meters × 1.0936 = Yards

## Weight: Ounces ↔ Grams

| OUNCES | GRAMS | OUNCES | GRAMS |
|--------|-------|--------|-------|
| 0.5    | 14    | 4      | 113   |
| 1      | 28    | 5      | 142   |
| 1.75   | 50    | 6      | 170   |
| 2      | 57    | 7      | 198   |

| OUNCES | GRAMS | OUNCES    | GRAMS |
|--------|-------|-----------|-------|
| 3      | 85    | 8         | 227   |
| 3.5    | 100   | 16 (1 lb) | 454   |

Quick Formula

Ounces × 28.3495 = Grams | Grams × 0.03527 = Ounces

Length: Inches ↔ Centimeters

| INCHES | CENTIMETERS | INCHES | CENTIMETERS |
|--------|-------------|--------|-------------|
| 0.25   | 0.64        | 12     | 30.5        |
| 0.5    | 1.27        | 14     | 35.6        |
| 1      | 2.54        | 16     | 40.6        |
| 2      | 5.08        | 18     | 45.7        |
| 4      | 10.2        | 20     | 50.8        |
| 6      | 15.2        | 24     | 61.0        |
| 8      | 20.3        | 36     | 91.4        |
| 10     | 25.4        | 48     | 121.9       |

Quick Formula

Inches × 2.54 = Centimeters | Centimeters × 0.3937 = Inches

Common Skein Sizes

| YARN WEIGHT | TYPICAL SKEIN  | APPROX. YARDAGE | APPROX. METERS |
|-------------|----------------|-----------------|----------------|
| Lace        | 50 g / 1.75 oz | 400–600 yds     | 366–549 m      |
| Fingering   | 50 g / 1.75 oz | 200–250 yds     | 183–229 m      |
| Sport       | 50 g / 1.75 oz | 140–170 yds     | 128–155 m      |
| DK          | 50 g / 1.75 oz | 120–150 yds     | 110–137 m      |

| YARN WEIGHT | TYPICAL SKEIN  | APPROX. YARDAGE | APPROX. METERS |
|-------------|----------------|-----------------|----------------|
| Worsted     | 100 g / 3.5 oz | 200–230 yds     | 183–210 m      |
| Bulky       | 100 g / 3.5 oz | 100–140 yds     | 91–128 m       |
| Super Bulky | 100 g / 3.5 oz | 60–90 yds       | 55–82 m        |
| Jumbo       | 250 g / 8.8 oz | 40–70 yds       | 37–64 m        |



## SECTION 6

# Care Symbols Guide

Decode the symbols on yarn labels so your finished pieces stay beautiful wash after wash.

*Standard textile care symbols are used worldwide. They appear on yarn bands and tell you exactly how to wash, dry, iron, and clean your knitted items.*

### Washing

**Tub icon** = machine washable. The number inside indicates maximum temperature in °C.

**30 °C** — Cold / delicate wash

**40 °C** — Warm wash

**60 °C** — Hot wash

**Tub with hand** — Hand wash only (max 40 °C)

**Tub with X** — Do not wash (dry clean only)

**Bar under tub** — Gentle / permanent press cycle

**Double bar** — Extra gentle / delicate cycle

### Bleaching

**Triangle** = bleaching allowed.

**Empty triangle** — Any bleach allowed

**Triangle with diagonal lines** — Non-chlorine / oxygen bleach only

**Triangle with X** — Do not bleach

**For knitters:** Most animal fibers (wool, alpaca, silk) must never be bleached. Cotton and linen tolerate oxygen bleach. When in doubt, skip the bleach.

## Drying

**Square icon** = drying instructions.

**Square with circle** — Tumble dry allowed

**One dot in circle** — Low heat

**Two dots in circle** — Normal / medium heat

**Square+circle with X** — Do not tumble dry

**Square with horizontal line** — Dry flat  
(standard for most knits)

**Square with arc at top** — Drip dry / line dry

## Ironing

**Iron icon** = ironing instructions.

**One dot** — Low heat (110 °C / 230 °F) —  
synthetics

**Two dots** — Medium heat (150 °C / 300 °F) —  
wool, silk

**Three dots** — High heat (200 °C / 390 °F) —  
cotton, linen

**Iron with X** — Do not iron

**Iron with X under** — Do not steam

**Tip:** Most knits should be steamed or blocked  
rather than pressed directly with an iron.

## Dry Cleaning

**Circle icon** = professional cleaning.

**P in circle** — Dry clean with  
perchloroethylene (standard solvent)

**F in circle** — Dry clean with petroleum solvent  
only

**W in circle** — Professional wet clean

**Circle with X** — Do not dry clean

**Bar under circle** — Gentle process

## Fiber Care Quick Reference

**Wool / Alpaca:** Hand wash cold, lay flat to  
dry, no bleach

**Merino Superwash:** Machine wash gentle  
cold, lay flat to dry

**Cotton / Linen:** Machine wash warm, can  
tumble dry low

**Silk:** Hand wash cold or dry clean, do not  
wring

**Acrylic:** Machine wash warm, tumble dry low

**Bamboo:** Hand wash or gentle cycle, lay flat

**Cashmere:** Hand wash cold, lay flat, no  
wringing

## Important

Always check the yarn label before washing a finished item. Different dye lots of the same yarn can sometimes have different care instructions.

## SECTION 7

# Yarn Substitution Guide

How to confidently swap one yarn for another without ruining your project.

*The yarn a pattern calls for might be discontinued, too expensive, or unavailable in your area. A smart substitution keeps your project on track.*

## The Substitution Decision Process

- 1 Match the yarn weight category.** This is the most critical factor. A DK substitute for a DK yarn is far more likely to work than crossing weight classes.
- 2 Check the gauge.** Even within the same weight category, gauge can vary. Swatch with the new yarn on the recommended needle size and compare to the pattern gauge.
- 3 Consider the fiber content.** Fiber affects drape, warmth, stretch, and stitch definition. A cotton DK and a wool DK behave very differently in a cable pattern.
- 4 Calculate the total yardage needed.** Substitute by yardage, not by number of skeins. If the pattern calls for 5 skeins at 220 yds each (1,100 yds total), you need 1,100 yds of the new yarn, regardless of its skein size.
- 5 Buy an extra skein.** Different yarn structures use fiber at different rates. An extra skein is cheap insurance.
- 6 Knit a full swatch.** Wash and block it. Check gauge, drape, and how you feel about the fabric before committing.

## Yardage Calculation

### Formula

**Total yards needed** = (pattern skeins) × (yards per skein of original yarn)

**Skeins of new yarn** = total yards needed ÷ (yards per skein of new yarn)

Always round UP and add one extra skein.

# Fiber Substitution Considerations

| IF THE PATTERN USES | GOOD SUBSTITUTES                              | CAUTION WITH                                         |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Wool                | Merino, wool blends, alpaca (for warmth)      | Cotton (no memory/stretch), acrylic (different hand) |
| Cotton              | Linen, bamboo, cotton blends                  | Wool (different drape, much warmer), stretchy yarns  |
| Alpaca              | Wool (for structure), alpaca blends, cashmere | Cotton (no warmth), plant fibers (no loft)           |
| Acrylic             | Acrylic blends, superwash wool (similar care) | Delicate fibers requiring hand wash                  |
| Silk                | Bamboo, Tencel, silk blends                   | Wool (less drape), cotton (less sheen)               |
| Linen               | Cotton, hemp, bamboo                          | Wool or acrylic (completely different character)     |

## When Fiber Properties Matter Most

|                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Stitch Definition Critical</b><br><br>Cables, textured patterns, colorwork. Use smooth, plied yarn with good memory (wool, wool blends). Avoid fuzzy singles or high-halo yarns. | <b>Drape Critical</b><br><br>Shawls, flowing garments, lace. Use fibers with drape: silk, bamboo, linen, Tencel. Avoid springy, bouncy wool unless the pattern was designed for it.     |
| <b>Warmth Critical</b><br><br>Winter accessories, heavy sweaters. Use wool, alpaca, cashmere, or warm blends. Plant fibers and silk provide little insulation.                      | <b>Durability Critical</b><br><br>Socks, bags, high-wear items. Use superwash wool/nylon blends, cotton, or acrylic. Avoid pure alpaca or silk (pill or wear quickly at stress points). |

## Common Substitution Pairs

| ORIGINAL YARN (EXAMPLE) | RELIABLE SUBSTITUTE OPTIONS                              | WEIGHT      |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 100% Merino worsted     | Any superwash merino worsted; merino/nylon blend worsted | 4 — Worsted |

| ORIGINAL YARN (EXAMPLE)           | RELIABLE SUBSTITUTE OPTIONS                                       | WEIGHT        |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Alpaca DK                         | Alpaca/wool blend DK; merino DK (add warmth layer)                | 3 — DK        |
| Cotton sport                      | Cotton/acrylic blend sport; bamboo sport                          | 2 — Sport     |
| Sock yarn (fingering, wool/nylon) | Any fingering-weight wool/nylon blend; superwash merino fingering | 1 — Fingering |
| Bulky single-ply wool             | Bulky plied wool; bulky wool/acrylic blend                        | 5 — Bulky     |
| Silk lace                         | Silk/merino lace blend; Tencel lace; bamboo lace                  | 0 — Lace      |

### Substitution Checklist

- ☐ Same yarn weight category
- ☐ Gauge swatch matches pattern gauge (after washing)
- ☐ Similar fiber content or compatible drape/stretch
- ☐ Total yardage calculated (not just skein count)
- ☐ Extra skein purchased
- ☐ Care requirements are acceptable
- ☐ Fabric hand and appearance are satisfying

### Don't Skip the Swatch

A substitution that looks perfect on paper can still fail in practice. Always knit, wash, and block a swatch before buying all the yarn for a large project.

## Next Step

Keep this toolkit within reach every time you knit. Open **The Great Stitch Library** to pick your next stitch pattern, then use the needle chart, gauge guide, and abbreviation glossary here to follow the instructions with confidence.